**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

**MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special**

**(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)**

**Examinations, July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)**

**Third SEMESTER**

**Value Addition Course(VAC) - MG3VACJMC200 - CITIZEN JOURNALISM**

**ANSWER SCHEME**

## Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. a). Fiction
2. a). Video editing apps
3. c). Hard news
4. a). Iranian protests in 2009
5. b). Mobile Journalism
6. b). Defamatory content
7. a). Creative works
8. b). Associated Press (AP)
9. c). Background and less important details
10. c). Agenda setting
11. a). Civic engagement
12. a). Blogger
13. b). People share sensational content without fact-checking
14. b). Maintains a strong commitment to political and social reform
15. b). Ensure truth and fairness

## Part B: Short Answer Type Questions

16. In-depth Journalism: Thorough, detailed reporting that goes beyond basic news facts to explore background context, underlying causes, systemic issues, and broader implications of an event using extensive research and multi-source verification.
17. Primary Sources of News: First-hand, direct witnesses, participants, or original official documents involved in an event. Examples include eyewitness accounts, official police reports, press conferences, public records, or interviews with direct victims.
18. Fake News: Sensational or manipulated content spreads rapidly via encrypted forwarding without verification due to peer trust, viral panic, or emotional appeals (e.g., doctored videos, false medical cures, or communal rumors).

19. Human Interest Stories: Feature stories focusing on personal experiences, emotions, struggles, or triumphs of individuals. They engage audiences emotionally, adding a relatable human face to complex news events or broad social issues.
20. Functions of News: Informs citizens about current affairs, educates the public, acts as a watchdog holding power accountable, shapes public discourse (agenda-setting), and provides essential commercial, cultural, and social utility to society.
21. Citizen Journalism: Public citizens playing an active role in collecting, reporting, analyzing, and disseminating news and information, primarily using digital tools, mobile devices, and social media platforms without formal journalistic training.
22. Podcasting & Platform: Digital audio files made available on the internet for downloading or streaming on demand, typically formatted as episodic series. Examples of popular platforms include Spotify, Apple Podcasts, or Google Podcasts.
23. Transparency in Citizen Journalism: Disclosing identity, sources, biases, and methodology builds audience trust, allows public verification, distinguishes credible user-generated content from propaganda or disinformation, and maintains accountability in non-traditional reporting.

**Part C: Essay Type Questions**

24. Challenges Faced by Citizen Journalists:
    - Lack of Legal & Physical Protection: Susceptibility to harassment, arrest, violence, and legal threats without institutional backing.
    - Ethical & Credibility Deficits: Risk of spreading unverified information, lacking formal training in verification, defamation laws, or journalistic standards.
    - Resource Constraints: Limited funding, professional camera/audio equipment, and editing infrastructure.
    - Algorithmic Shadowbanning & Censorship: Account suspensions, platform policy changes, internet blackouts, and government censorship.
25. Significance of Journalistic Ethics:
    - Combating Disinformation: Essential for filtering out deepfakes, paid news, and sensationalized misinformation in digital spaces.
    - Preserving Public Trust: Upholding accuracy, objectivity, and fairness maintains democratic reliance on news.
    - Harm Minimization: Respecting privacy, protecting vulnerable sources/minors, and preventing hate speech or panic.
    - Accountability: Ensuring rights of reply, corrections, and conflict-of-interest disclosures.
26. History and Growth of Citizen Journalism:
    - Early Roots: Pamphleteering, public forums, and early open-publishing networks (e.g., Indymedia late 1990s).

- Milestone Events: Coverage of the 2004 Asian Tsunami, 2005 London Bombings, and 2009 Iranian Protests using early camera phones and blogs.
- Social Media Boom: Arab Spring (2011) and widespread adoption of platforms like Twitter/X, Facebook, YouTube, and WhatsApp.
- Modern Era: Integration of MoJo (Mobile Journalism) tools, livestreaming, hyper-local blogging, and citizen-led watchdog networks.

27. Techniques Used in Interviews:
    - Preparation & Research: Topic backgrounding, defining goals, and drafting open-ended key questions.
    - Questioning Strategies: Moving from general warm-up queries to specific probing questions; using follow-ups based on active listening.
    - Building Rapport: Establishing trust, active body language, maintaining neutral non-verbal cues, and handling sensitive topics with empathy.
    - Technical Execution: Recording permissions, microphone positioning, ambient noise control, and clear note-taking/transcription discipline.